Briefing Session on 2023 HKDSE Geography Examination

30 Oct & 2 Nov 2023

HKDSE Geography Assessment Frameworks

Year	Remarks	Major amendments
2024	Interim Resumption Arrangement	FBQ: Optional FBQ topic: Climate Change (assigned)
2025 onwards	Normal	FBQ: Compulsory

2024 Interim Resumption Arrangement

	Paper 1	Paper 2
Weighting:	75%	25%
Duration:	2¾ hours	1¼ hour
Scope:	Compulsory Part	Elective Part
Section/ Question type:	A. Multiple-choice (20%) B. Fieldwork-based & Data/Skill-based/ Structured (15% → 45%) ~~C. Data/Skill-based/ Structure~~ ~~(30%)~~ ~~D~~ C.Short Essay (10%)	~~E~~ D.Data/Skill-based/ Structured (15%) ~~F~~ E.Short Essay (10%)

2023 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

	Year	2023	2022	2021	2020
No of candidates	SCH/1	**6 822**	7 221	7 566	8 042
	WG	**7 188**	7 567	7 957	8 381

2023 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

Level	2023	2022	2021	2020
5**	1.3	1.2	1.3	1.2
5*	5.1	4.9	5.1	4.9
5	12.5	12.5	12.9	11.9
4	37.7	37.3	39.1	38.3
3	63.2	62.8	65.8	64.7
2	88.4	88.0	88.6	88.2
1	97.9	97	97.5	97.5
U	2.1	3.0	2.5	2.5

Figures refers to Day Schools (SCH/1) %

2023 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

Year	Mean (% mark)	SD (% mark)
2020	45.93	13.59
2021	45.61	14.10
2022	45.52	14.72
2023	**48.3**	**14.03**
Diff (2023-22)	**2.78**	**-0.69**

Figures refers to Day Schools (SCH/1) %

2023 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

MCQ Statistics				
	2023	**2022**	**2021**	**2020**
Mean (% mark)	**12.33 (61.65)**	11.22 (56.10)	9.86 (49.30)	12.01 (60.05)
SD (% mark)	**3.17 (15.85)**	2.91 (14.55)	2.86 (14.30)	2.82 (14.10)
Lowest	**1**	0	1	1
Highest	**20**	19	19	20

Total no. of MCQ : 20

Figures refers to Day Schools (SCH/1) %

2023 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

	Paper 1							
	Q1 (18)	**Q2 (18)**	**Q3 (18)**	**Q4 (18)**	**Q5 (18)**	**Q6 (12)**	**Q7 (12)**	**Q8 (12)**
Mean Score *(% marks)*	2.93 *(16.3)*	9.52 *(52.9)*	9.81 *(54.5)*	7.01 *(38.9)*	8.50 *(47.2)*	3.51 *(29.3)*	3.13 *(26.1)*	3.18 *(26.5)*
Highest Score	**11**	**18**	**18**	**16**	**16**	**12**	**10**	**12**
Popularity (%)	1	52	60	11	75	21	56	21

2023 HKDSE Geography
Report on Examination Statistics

	Paper 2							
	Q1 (18)	**Q2 (18)**	**Q3 (18)**	**Q4 (18)**	**Q5 (12)**	**Q6 (12)**	**Q7 (12)**	**Q8 (12)**
Mean Score *(% marks)*	7.98 *(44.3)*	10.46 *(58.1)*	7.79 *(43.3)*	9.38 *(52.1)*	3.80 *(31.7)*	3.19 *(26.6)*	0.74 *(6.2)*	3.08 *(25.7)*
Highest Score	**18**	**18**	**16**	**18**	**11**	**11**	**6**	**11**
Popularity (%)	39	27	9	25	55	21	3	20

School Survey on the 2023 HKDSE Geography Examination Papers

*The **duration** of the examination is appropriate.*

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
8.0%	71.2%	13.6%	6.4%	0.8%	0.0%

*The level of **difficulty** of the examination is appropriate.*

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
4.8%	68.0%	20.0%	4.8%	2.4%	0.0%

School Survey on the 2023 HKDSE Geography Examination Papers

*The examination reflects the assessment **aims & objectives** stated in the **C & A Guide**.*

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
5.6%	77.6%	15.2%	1.6%	0.0%	0.0%

*The examination is well-balanced in terms of **curriculum coverage**.*

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
8.9%	73.4%	13.7%	3.2%	0.0%	0.8%

School Survey on the 2023 HKDSE Geography Examination Papers

*An appropriate **balance** between questions testing **basic knowledge / skills & those testing higher-order skills.***

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
6.4%	76.0%	13.6%	2.4%	1.6%	0.0%

*The **wording** of the questions is clear & easily understandable.*

Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree
5.6%	71.2%	19.2%	2.4%	1.6%	0.0%

School Survey on the 2023 HKDSE Geography Examination Papers

*The **optional questions** are at a* comparable ***level of difficulty**.*

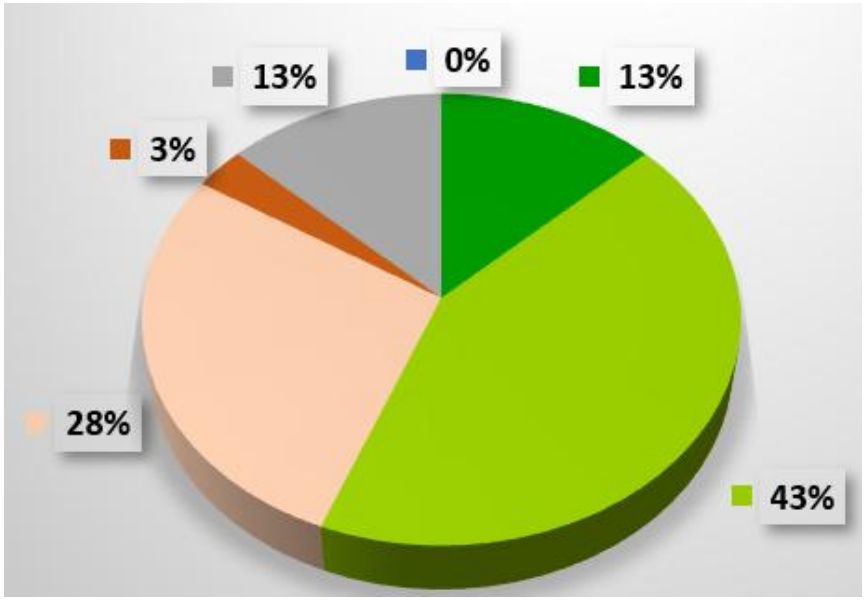
Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree	N.A.
2.4%	62.1%	25.0%	0.8%	2.4%	1.6%	5.6%

*The **two language versions** are identical in meaning.*

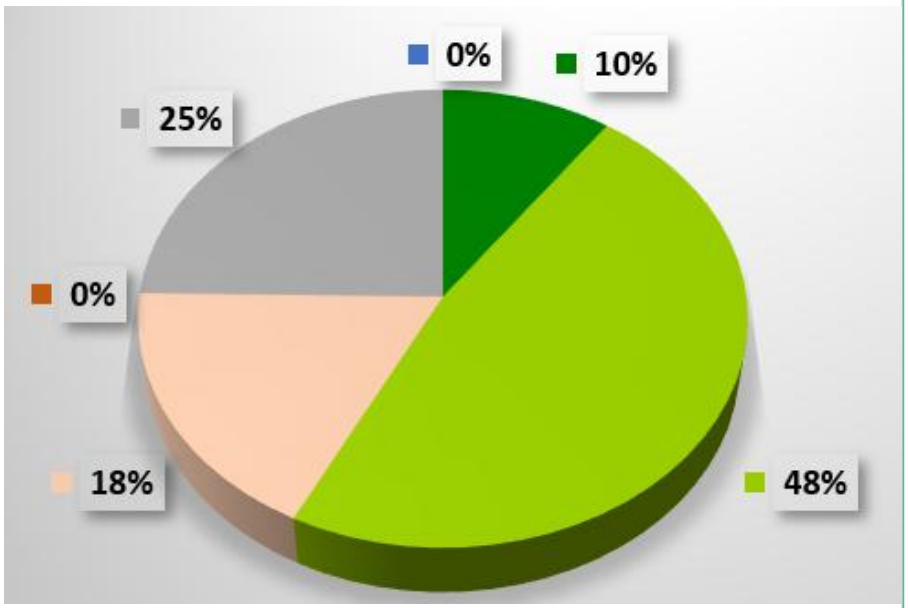
Strongly agree	Agree	Slightly agree	Slightly disagree	Disagree	Strongly disagree	N.A.
5.6%	68.8%	8.8%	0.8%	0.8%	0.8%	14.4%

Comments from Markers on Candidates' Standard Compared with 2022 Examination

Paper 1



Paper 2



much better
Slightly better
about the same
slightly poorer
much poorer
N.A.

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Review of Candidates' Performance

2023 Geography Paper 1

General comments and observations I

Compared to previous years, candidates showed improvement in the following aspects.

- Candidates generally demonstrated a basic understanding of each module.
- In Section A, the overall performance of candidates was satisfactory. There was a slight improvement in the overall performance of candidates as compared with last year.
- In Section B, the sub-questions about basic geographical concepts and issues of each module were mostly well answered.
- In Section C, most candidates performed fairly in the first part of the questions. Candidates demonstrated basic to intermediate understanding of the relevant content stated in the first part of the question.
- Overall, their answers were more organised and structured, containing appropriate geographical knowledge.

Section B – Question 2

Popularity – 52%

Question No.		Performance
(a)	(i)	Satisfactory
	(ii)	Fair
(b)	(i)	Very good
	(ii)	Satisfactory
(c)		Fair

Section B – Question 2

(a) Refer to Figure 2a.

(i) Identify tectonic landform feature A. (1 mark)

(b) Refer to Figure 2b and Table 2c.

(i) Account for the adverse socio-economic impacts brought about by the eruption of volcano X.

(4 marks)

- ✓ Explaining the impact of emission of volcanic ash
- ✓ Not include lava as an ejecta
- ✓ Responding to the data

(ii) *One person died in this volcanic eruption.*

With evidence from Figure 2b and Table 2c, explain the low death toll. (4 marks)

- ✓ Factors affecting the death toll
- ✓ Quoting evidence from Table 2c, including "time factor" & "actions taken by the government"

Section B – Question 3

Popularity – 60%

Question No.		Performance
(a)		Excellent
(b)		Fair
(c)	(i)	Fair
	(ii)	Poor

(a) Quote evidence from Figure 3a, account for the location of the iron and steel production centre X before the 1950s. (6 marks)

- ✓ Factors of industrial location
- ✓ Map interpretation
- ✓ Quoting map evidence

Section B – Question 5

Popularity – 75%

Question No.		Performance
(a)		Poor
(b)	(i)	Very good
	(ii)	Very good
(c)		Poor
(d)		Poor

(b) Refer to Figure 5b. With reference to

(i) climatic conditions, and (3 marks)

(ii) socio-economic conditions, (5 marks)

account for the food shortage problem in country X.

- ✓ Accurate explanation
- ✓ Good geographical knowledge
- ✓ Good use of the data

Exceptional cases

Points to note

- identifying conventional signs
- drawing and labelling diagrams
- describing spatial distribution

Section A

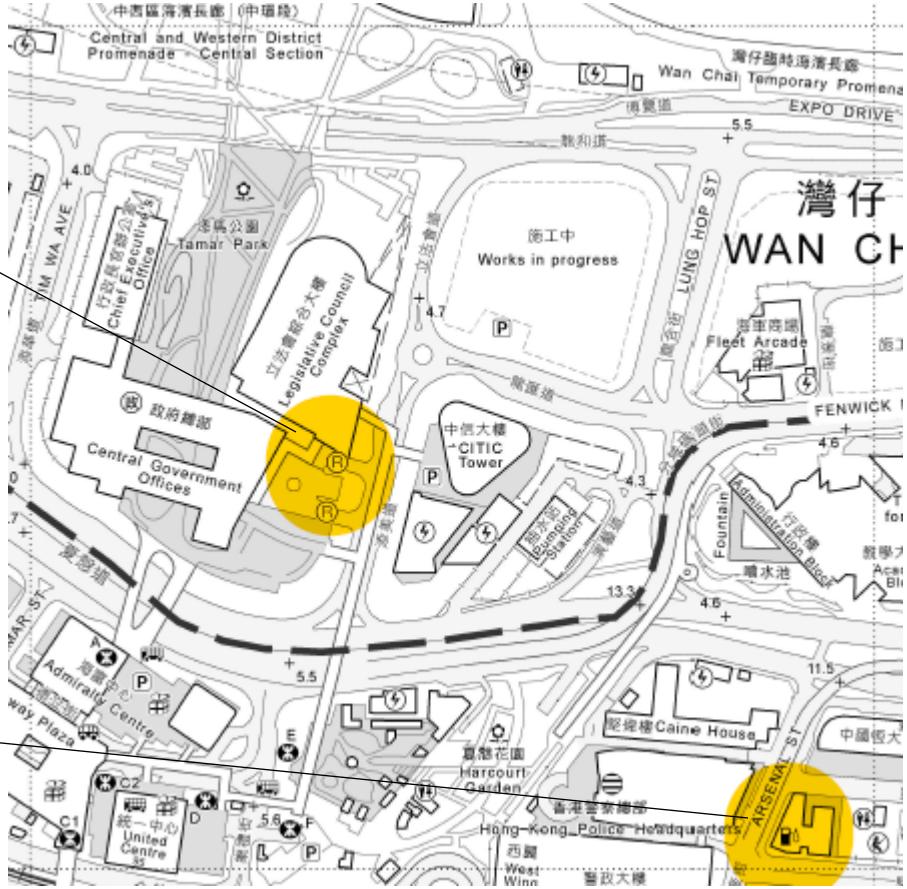
- There was a slight improvement in the overall performance of candidates as compared with last year.
- In Item 2, the most popular answer was Option C.

A.	car park	3%
B.	green minibus terminus	24%
C.	restricted access	46%
D.*	LPG filling station	26%

Section A

Two Ⓡ at grid reference 513114 representing restricted access were overlooked.

It is a Petrol Station but NOT a LPG filling station.



Section B – Question 2

Areas for improvement:

(a) Refer to Figure 2a.

(ii) Draw a series of annotated diagrams to explain the coexistence of the tectonic landform feature A and the active volcanoes along the plate boundary. (5 marks)

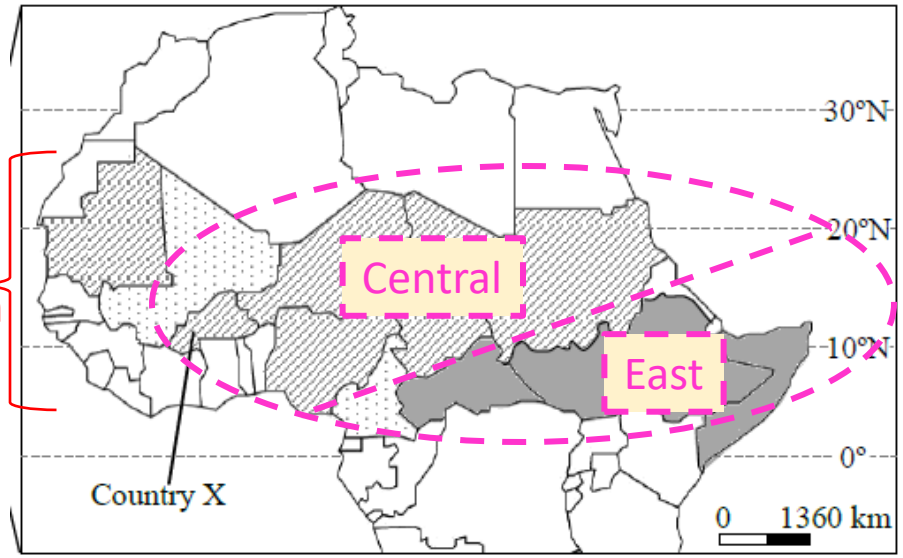
- Annotations are expected to be labelled/adhered to the drawings explaining the formation of landform feature A
- Texts next to the drawings are not regarded as “annotations”
- Some candidates drew the volcanoes on the wrong plate
- Some candidates identified the feature as fold mountain and gave wrong explanation about the formation

Section B – Question 5

Areas for improvement:

(a) Refer to Figure 5a. Describe the distribution pattern of countries facing levels of high and medium risk food shortage problem in Africa. (3 marks)

Commonly missing:
- Latitudinal Range
- Name of the region



Specific description/ spatial distribution was missing

General comments and recommendations II

General answering skills

- Candidates should read the questions more carefully.
- Candidates should pay attention to the question words.
- Candidates should respond to the questions carefully.
- Directive words such as “how” and “why” were confused.

Section B – Question 3

Areas for improvement:

(c) Refer to Table 3c.

(ii) Under the technological improvement mentioned in (c)(i), discuss how the location of the iron and steel industry in China may be affected. (4 marks)

- ✓ Most candidates explained the locational change as "from inland to coastal".
- ✓ Many candidates described the change in locational pull of raw materials and power resources.

- ➢ More elaboration on other factors should be given
- ➢ More description about distribution pattern should be given

Section B – Question 5

Areas for improvement:

(c) Refer to Figure 5c. Explain how the measures provided by the World Food Programme affect the food supply of country X. (3 marks)

- Many candidates did not recognise the measures provided in Figure 5c as a one-off measure.
- Much irrelevant explanation of aid provided to improve farming productivity in the long run.

Figure 5c

One-off measures provided by the World Food Programme to the people in country X	
- food aid - financial assistance	

General comments and recommendations III

Use of data and information provided

- Candidates should not merely copy the data and information from the figures provided.
- Candidates should provide further elaboration and explanation.
- Candidates should explain the arguments with the use of the data provided for the open-ended questions.
- Candidates should apply their knowledge appropriately to the specific situations stated in the questions.

Section B – Question 3

Areas for improvement:

(b) *The iron and steel production centre X was founded in 1916.*

Refer to Figure 3a and Table 3b. What are the reasons for the iron and steel production centre X to remain in its original location in the 1980s? (3 marks)

Table 3b

1980s
Measures adopted to solve some prevailing problems of the iron and steel production centre X : • modernising plants with the cost of approximately 3.4 billion RMB • expanding the production of iron ore mines nearby with the cost of approximately 1.5 billion RMB

- Failed to explain the existing locational advantages
- Only connected the answer to the advantages of long history of development

Section B – Question 3

Areas for improvement:

(c) Refer to Table 3c.

(i) Explain how the improvement in the technological level in the 2010s might have affected the inputs and production of the iron and steel production centre X. (5 marks)

➢ Interpret data but NOT copy!!!

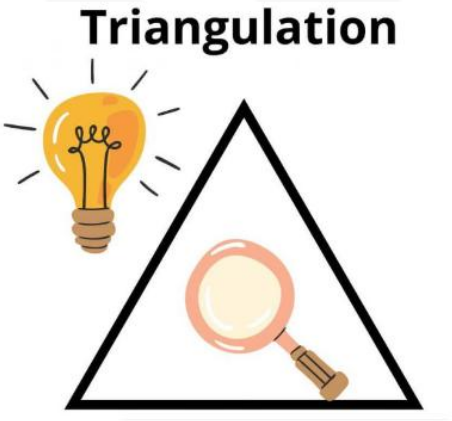
Table 3c

2010s
Inputs: higher capital & labour with higher education level Production: higher automation & higher productivity • making use of the government funds on research and development • using wastewater, waste heat and scrap steel • using 5G technology and the internet • upgrading the blast furnace to reduce the emission of pollutants Inputs: less raw materials/ energy Inputs: more advanced information technology Production: more environmentally friendly

Other reminders

Highest order task – open-ended questions

- referring to the data
- using evidence without copying
- explanation and/or conclusion



Section B – Question 2

Areas for improvement:

(c) *It is suggested that all human activities within 20km from volcano X should be banned.*

Refer to Figure 2a, Figure 2b and Table 2c. Discuss the appropriateness of this suggestion. (4 marks)

- ✓ More candidates connected the answers to economic activities (e.g., farming and tourism) and their associated returns in the area.
- ➢ Some candidates mistakenly mentioned additional tectonic hazards (e.g., tsunamis) triggered by volcanic ash eruptions.
- ➢ Others failed to identify and explain the banning act as "land-use zoning".

Section B – Question 5

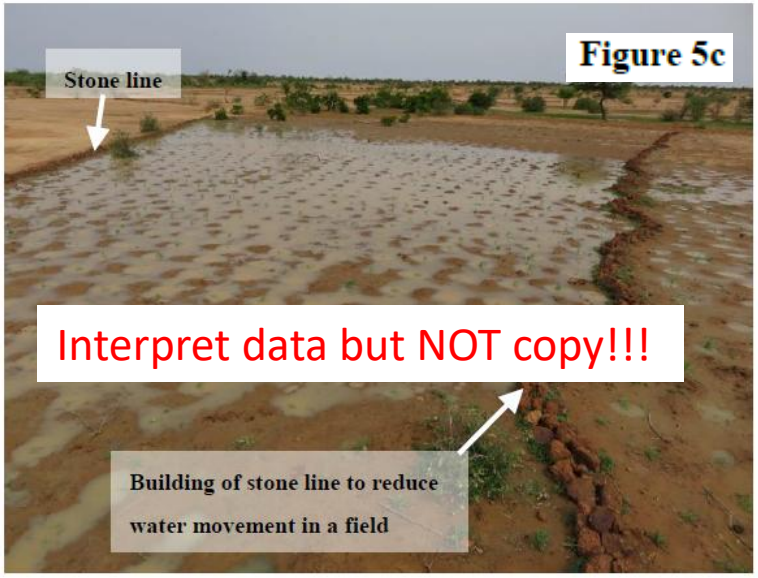
Areas for improvement:

(d) *Arable farming and pastoral farming are the two major agricultural activities in country X.*

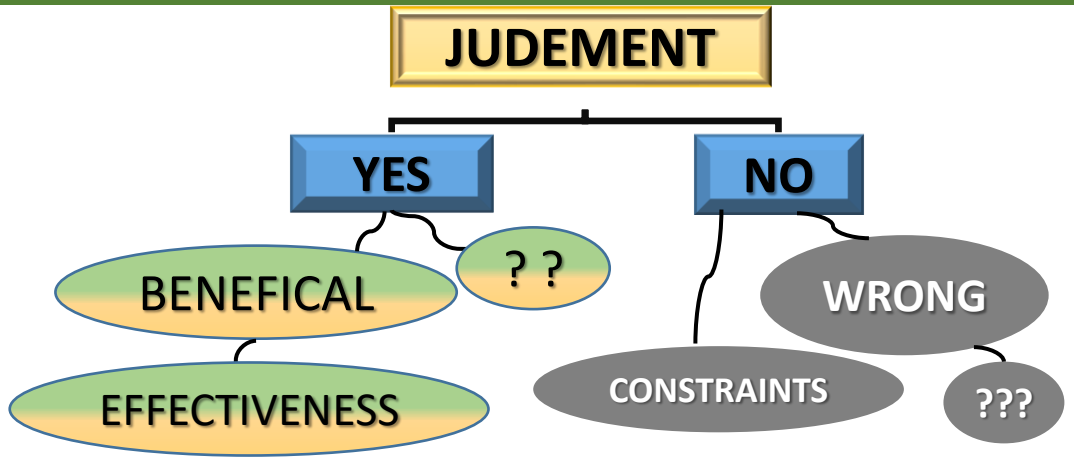
Refer to Figure 5a, Figure 5b and the photograph shown in Figure 5c.

Discuss whether the building of stone lines in the fields may increase the local food production in country X in the long run. (4 marks)

- Majority discussed the climatic constraints but rarely considered other settings such as the land carrying capacity and availability of local resources
- Much irrelevant explanation of salinisation as a negative impact of stone line was given.
- Brief explanation of the pros and/or limitations of stone lines was given



Important reminder



Marking criteria:

- **Logical** and well-elaborated explanations/ arguments with reference to the **information** provided, demonstrating good **knowledge** and understanding of sustainable agricultural development in Sahel - With appropriate **judgement**	4
- A sound explanation/ argument in greater detail with reference to the information provided, demonstrating adequate knowledge and understanding of sustainable agricultural development in Sahel, OR - Two or more appropriate explanations/ arguments demonstrating adequate knowledge and understanding	3
- An appropriate explanation/ argument demonstrating basic knowledge and understanding of sustainable agricultural development in Sahel, OR - More than one brief explanations/ arguments demonstrating basic knowledge and understanding	2
- One brief explanation/ argument demonstrating elementary knowledge and understanding of agricultural characteristics in Sahel	1

Section B – Question 1

Popularity – 1%

Q No.		Performance	Explanatory notes
(a)		Poor	Lack of explanation
(b)		Poor	Able to mentioned fairness as the reason but failed to explain how the fairness was kept by stratified sampling
(c)	(i)	Satisfactory	/
	(ii)	Poor	Failed to interpret the scatter diagram in terms of the orientation of the best-fit line, the distribution of data points and the distance between data points and the best-fit line
(d)		Poor	Few were able to describe the drawbacks of the current practices and give appropriate suggestions in response to the context of the current fieldwork and the setting of the field site for improvement

Section B – Question 4

Popularity – 11%

Q. No.		Performance	Explanatory notes
(a)	(i)	Fair	Candidates performed better on describing the commercial land use pattern, but relatively worse on the road network pattern.
	(ii)	Good	/
	(iii)	Fair	Commonly missing content: an increase in road capacity, diverting traffic flow
(b)	(i)	Fair	Existing favourable factors (such as existing reclaimed land and existing transport facilities) were overlooked.
	(ii)	Poor	Candidates did not have a clear understanding of social sustainability. Common among such candidates were explanations of other impacts that were not relevant to social issues, for example, more job and economic opportunities or better air quality.

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2023 Geography Paper 1 Section C

Section C – Question 7

Popularity – 56%
Performance – Fair

Part	Explanatory notes
1st	✓ most candidates demonstrated a basic to intermediate understanding of different commercial agricultural activities in tropical rainforests, i.e. plantation and cattle ranching ✓ most were able to explain the changes in the vegetation characteristics of tropical rainforests, including density, amount, species diversity and structure ➢ irrelevant content: quite a number of candidates failed to distinguish between commercial agricultural activities and other human activities causing deforestation

Section C – Question 6

Popularity – 21%
Performance – Satisfactory

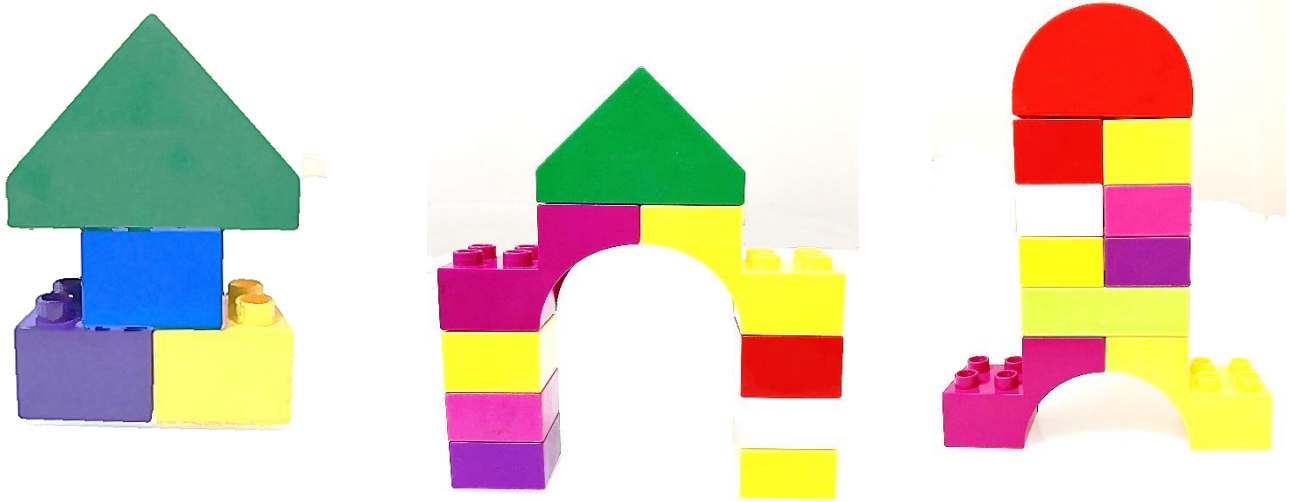
Part	Explanatory notes
1st	✓ demonstrated a basic to intermediate understanding of the physical conditions favouring deposition at the lower course ✓ able to describe and explain multiple factors leading to deposition at the lower course ✓ some were able to relate the conditions with the amount of river energy to explain the deposition ✓ some demonstrated a good understanding of the interplay between the river's energy and the physical conditions favouring deposition ➢ irrelevant content including work of waves, depositional features and their formations ➢ confuse the coastal and fluvial processes

Section C – Question 8

Popularity – 21%
Performance – Fair

Part	Explanatory notes
1st	✓ most candidates described and explained the adverse impacts, including sea level rise, changes in water supply, alterations in rainfall patterns, melting of sea and land ice, and other relevant impacts ✓ able to provide examples to support their answers ➢ irrelevant content: some candidates included other impacts, such as the impacts on biodiversity, soil and climate

Important reminder



Encourage students to try to elaborate the answers because,

- ✓ Marks will be awarded when the content and explanation are accurate and appropriate.
- ✓ Even if the wording differs from the marking scheme, marks will be awarded if the content is logical and appropriate.
- ✓ Each correct & logical response will be tallied and counted.

Section C – Question 6

Part	Explanatory notes
2nd	✓ The most common channelisation methods covered: widening, straightening and deepening ➢ did not focus on discussion of the recent practices ➢ many candidates only focused on the negative impacts of channelisation, especially on the environmental aspects and provided inadequate content to explain how the recent practices enhanced sustainability ✓ some demonstrated understanding of the **latest** development of channelisation, such as fish ladders and green channelisation ✓ such candidates demonstrated a good understanding of the need to adopt sustainable channelisation practices to manage the river environment in Hong Kong ✓ relevant examples were also provided to support their answers.

Section C – Question 7

Part	Explanatory notes
2nd	➢ a lack of understanding of the concept of agroforestry ➢ most candidates were unable to give descriptions of agroforestry ➢ failed to explain the pros and limitations ➢ misconceptions: quite a number of candidates mistakenly explained the practice as afforestation

Section C – Question 8

Part	Explanatory notes
2nd	➢ some candidates suggested relevant measures, such as artificial rain, desalination, and provided good explanations as to how to alleviate the adverse impact ✓ most candidates failed to respond to the question words advanced technology ✓ explanations of the limitations of the use of advanced technology to alleviate the adverse impact was too brief and general

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Thank You

Q&A

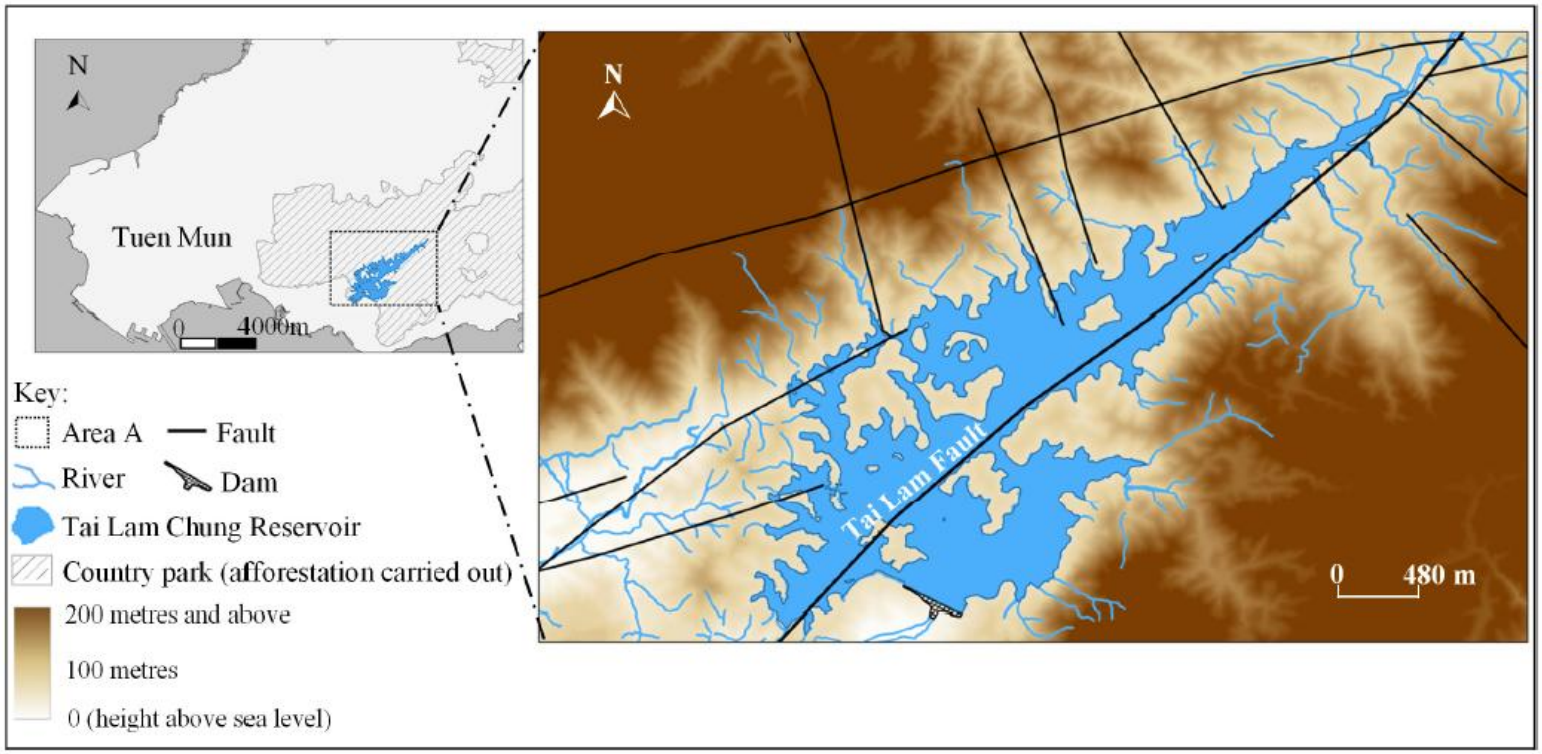
Review of Candidates' Performance

2023 Geography Paper 2

Section D: Question 1

Figure 1a shows the location of area A. Photograph 1b shows a landform feature found in area A. Figure 1c shows a specimen and the structure of a kind of igneous rock found in area A. Figure 1d shows some information about the rainfall characteristics in Hong Kong.

Figure 1a



Section D: Question 1 (cont.)

Photograph 1b

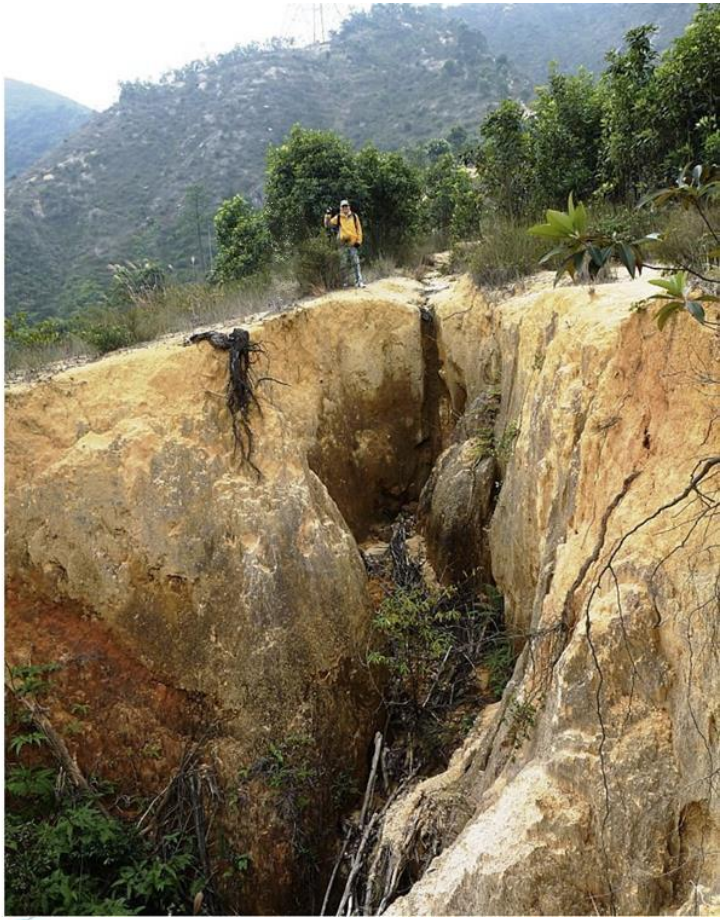


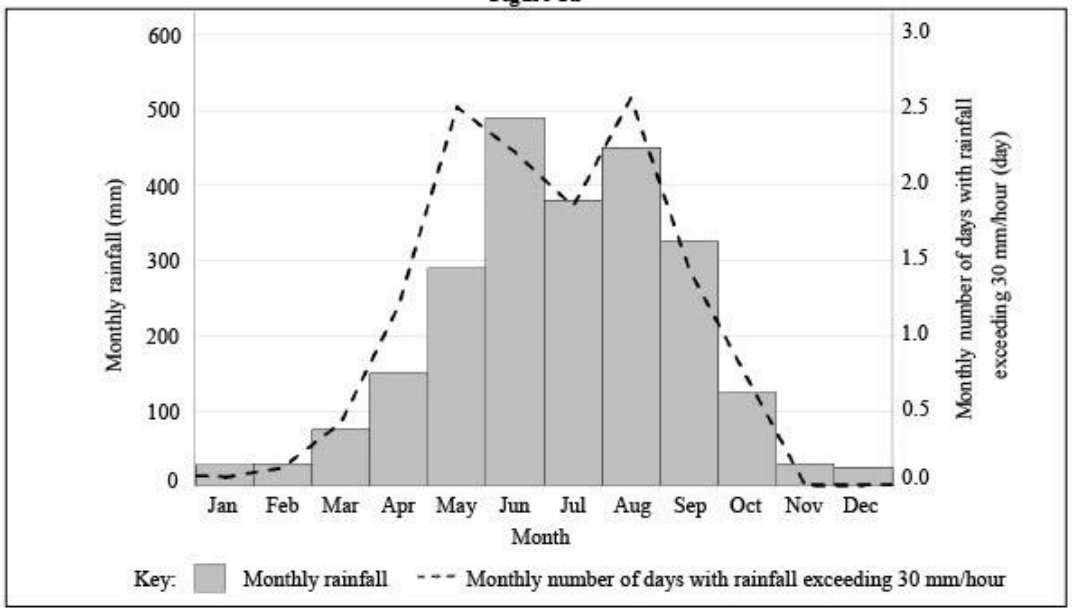
Figure 1c





Section D: Question 1 (cont.)

Figure 1d



(a) Refer to Figure 1a.

(i) Describe the orientation of Tai Lam Fault. (1 mark)

(ii) Explain how the faulting system shapes the physical landscape of area A. (5 marks)

Section D: Question 1 (cont.)

(b) Refer to Photograph 1b, Figure 1c and Figure 1d. With reference to

(i) the geological characteristics of the area, and (4 marks)

(ii) the rainfall characteristics of Hong Kong, (4 marks)

account for the formation of the landform feature shown in Photograph 1b.

(c) Refer to Figure 1a, Photograph 1b and Figure 1c. Comment on the impact of human activities on the physical landscape in area A. (4 marks)

Section D: Question 1 (cont.)

Curriculum Content – Dynamic Earth

Part (a):

Physical landscape of Hong Kong

- Major geological features (faults) in Hong Kong
- Internal processes: faulting

Parts (b):

Physical landscape of Hong Kong and processes shaping it

- Rock types
- External processes: weathering, erosion

Parts (c):

Modification of Hong Kong landscapes by urban development

Section D: Question 1 (cont.)

- **What most candidates knew:**

✓ Correct description of orientation of Tai Lam Fault

✓ Faults were less resistant to weathering and erosion

✓ Correct identification of granite

✓ Correct description of rainfall characteristics in Hong Kong

✓ Granite is susceptible to chemical weathering processes

✓ Correct identification of badland / gully

Section D: Question 1 (cont.)

- **Common mistakes / Misconceptions of candidates:**

× Confused fault with joint and weathering with erosion

× Named the resultant landscape as ‘lowland’ instead of ‘valley’

× Stated the reservoir as formed directly by erosion along the fault

× Physical weathering (caused by rainfall) took place in granite area to form badlands

× Wind erosion / rainwater caused slumping / forming badlands

× Building the reservoir increased water supply to intensify weathering and erosion

× ‘Afforestation led to **biological** weathering which brought negative effects to the area’

Section D: Question 1 (cont.)

- **Directions for better performance:**

➢ Better understanding of geographical terminology (e.g. weathering, mass-wasting and erosion)

➢ Better understanding of the relationship between different physical processes and landforms

➢ Better understanding of the major physical processes that occurred in the local landscape

➢ Learn the human impact on the natural environment by genuine examples / field studies

Section D: Question 2

(a) Refer to Figure 2a.

(i) In which season is the northern hemisphere? (1 mark)

(ii) Describe and explain the temperature distribution pattern in the northern hemisphere. (6 marks)

Section D: Question 2 (cont.)

(b) Refer to Figure 2b.

(i) Contrast the wind direction and wind speed in cities A and B. (3 marks)

(ii) Explain the answer in (b)(i) with reference to the pressure system shown in the figure. (4 marks)

(c) Refer to Figure 2b. Hong Kong is close to city B. Explain why the temperature and precipitation in Hong Kong are different from those of city B on the same day. (4 marks)

Section D: Question 2 (cont.)

Curriculum Content - Weather and Climate

Part (a):

Controlling factors of the climatic system

- Global temperature distribution pattern

Parts (b) & (c):

Climate of China

- Seasonal occurrence of weather systems in Hong Kong and the Zhujiang Delta Region: formation and impact - cold fronts

Section D: Question 2 (cont.)

- **What most candidates knew:**

✓Correct identification of the ‘winter’ season

✓Correct description of the latitudinal change of temperature distribution pattern

✓Correct explanation of the pattern by referring to the angle of sun and different heating properties of land and ocean

✓Correct interpretation of weather symbols

✓Explanation of the wind speed and direction by referring to pressure difference and Coriolis force

✓Good account of the formation of ‘frontal rain’

Section D: Question 2 (cont.)

- **Common mistakes / Misconceptions of candidates:**

× *'Thicker atmosphere' and 'longer distance from the Sun' in higher latitudes*

× Wrongly comparing the temperature pattern of North and South Hemispheres

× Wrongly stating the unit of wind speed as 'km/hour'

× Mistook cold front (a weather system) for the pressure system to influence the wind speed and direction

× Wrong identification of temperature and precipitation in Hong Kong and city B

× Wrongly explained their differences by factors of 'latitude' and 'distance from sea'

Section D: Question 2 (cont.)

- **Directions for better performance:**

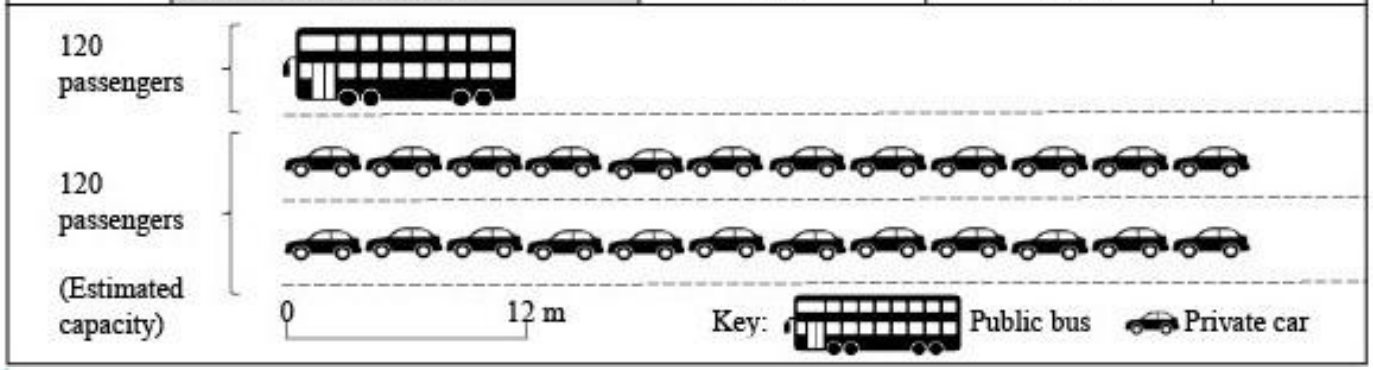
- Better understanding of the difference between ‘weather’ and ‘climate’ and the related phenomena and data
- Better training to read into questions and write statements more precisely
- Learn the weather systems by daily observations and / or genuine case studies

Section D: Question 3

Figure 3a shows the number of different types of passenger-carrying vehicles in Hong Kong in 2011 and 2021 and a graph showing the estimated road space used by different vehicles. Figure 3b shows some information about population and traffic flow in district A of Hong Kong, and the land use in the town centre of the district. Photograph 3c shows the common traffic conditions on road Y during rush hours.

Figure 3a

	2011	2021
Private cars	471 685	656 973
Public buses	12 892	13 162
Public light buses	4 350	4 349
Taxi	18 138	18 163
Total	507 065	692 647
Total road length (km)	2 086	2 193

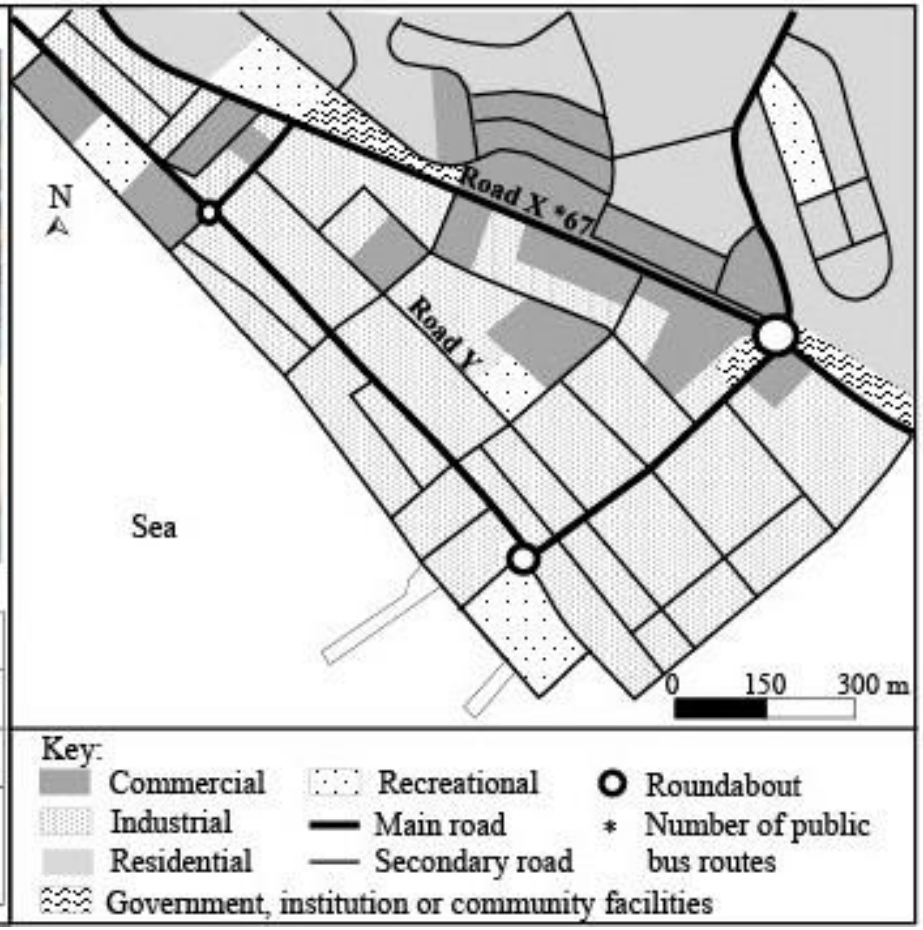


Section D: Question 3 (cont.)

Figure 3b



		2009	2019
Population of district A	**Residential**	594 400	688 500
	Working	300 300	352 300
Traffic flow of road X (Number of vehicles)		53 740	82 320



Section D: Question 3 (cont.)

Photograph 3c



(a) Refer to Figure 3a.

(i) Compare the growth of the number of passenger-carrying vehicles and the total road length in Hong Kong between 2011 and 2021. (3 marks)

Section D: Question 3 (cont.)

(ii) State the advantages of public buses over private cars on the use of road space. Explain your answer. (3 marks)

(b) According to a public opinion survey, 80.2% of residents in district A agreed that the traffic in the town centre of the district was very congested' .

Refer to Figure 3b. Explain why the traffic problem occurred in the town centre of district A. (5 marks)

(c) Refer to Photograph 3c. Suggest road traffic management measures that may ease the traffic congestion problem at road Y. (3 marks)

(d) Refer to Figure 3a, Figure 3b and Photograph 3c.

To improve the traffic conditions in district A, it has been proposed to develop the bus-rapid transit along road X. Discuss the feasibility of the proposal. (4 marks)

Section D: Question 3 (cont.)

Curriculum Content – Transport Development, Planning and Management

Part (a):

The development of transport and logistics in Hong Kong

- Major transport modes in Hong Kong

Part (b):

Transport problems in Hong Kong - traffic congestion

Parts (c) & (d):

Transport planning and traffic management in Hong Kong

- Various measures involved in managing road use in Hong Kong
- BRT

Section D: Question 3 (cont.)

- **What most candidates knew:**

✓Correct comparison of the growth of vehicles and road length

✓Correctly stating that buses had larger passenger-carrying capacity and lower occupancy of road space than those of private cars

✓Good use of data provided by question e.g. population and land use of district A, traffic flow of road X

✓Took note of the impact of roundabouts and large number of bus routes on traffic congestion

Section D: Question 3 (cont.)

- **Common mistakes / Misconceptions of candidates:**

× Did not recognise that private cars showed the largest increase in number

× Failed to work out the ratio between buses and private cars in terms of passenger-carrying capacity and road space occupied correctly

× Did not take the large number of road junctions and queuing of buses at bus stops into account in explaining the traffic problem

× Wrongly suggest ‘widening of roads’ or ‘banning of good vehicles’ as feasible traffic management measures

× Limited understanding of bus-rapid transit (BRT)

Section D: Question 3 (cont.)

- **Directions for better performance:**

➢Better interpretation of traffic data in accounting for the related problems and solutions

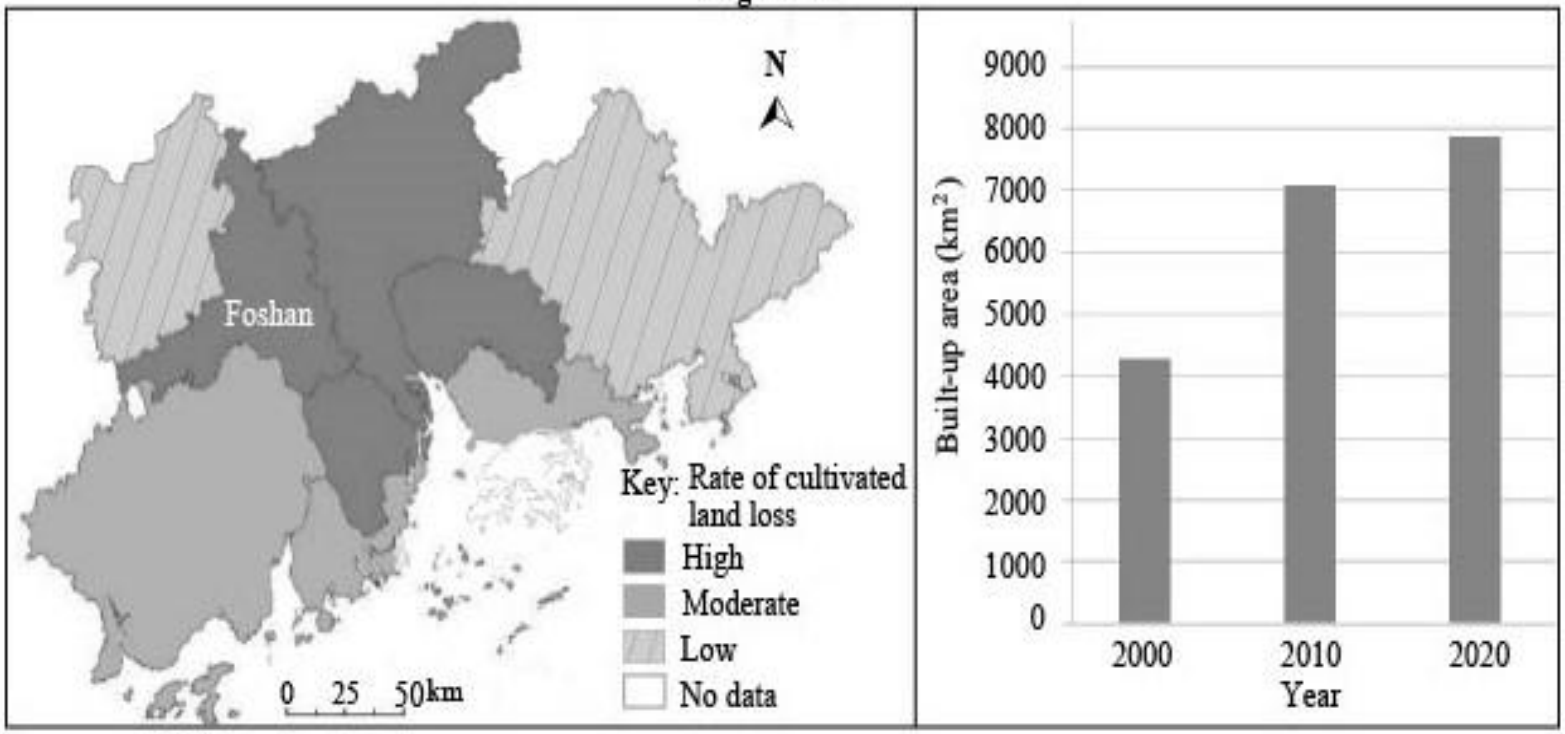
➢Better understanding of ‘traffic management’

➢Better understanding of the feasibility of transport innovations to solve traffic problems in Hong Kong

Section D: Question 4

Figure 4a shows the rate of cultivated land loss and the changes of built-up area in the Zhujiang Delta Region between 2000 and 2020. Table 4b shows some socio-economic information about Foshan. Figure 4c shows the practice at Flower Production Centre A located in Foshan.

Figure 4a



Section D: Question 4 (cont.)

Table 4b

		2000	2008	2018
GDP per capita (RMB)		20 231	68 666	128 216
Share of GDP (%)	**Primary industry**	5.9	2.2	1.4
	Secondary and tertiary industries	94.1	97.8	98.6
Major farm products (% share in total output)	**Rice**	17.1	6.4	4.7
	Vegetables and fruits	82.9	93.6	95.3
Total cultivated area of rice, vegetables and fruits (hectares)		138 074	82 192	42 906
Farming labour (% of population)		No data	7.0	3.6
Total highway length (km)		3 528	5 089	5 265
Agricultural policy		- Help farmers obtain bank loans - Provide farm work training to farmers		

Section D: Question 4 (cont.)

Figure 4c

Annual revenue (RMB) in 2019	2 billion
Major markets	Japan, European countries, the US and local market
Facilities and other activities	- Flower theme park - Flower exhibitions

Farming technology X used in Flower Production Centre A





Section D: Question 4 (cont.)

(a) Refer to Figure 4a. Describe and explain the changes in cultivated land in Zhujiang Delta Region between 2000 and 2020. (4 marks)

(b) Refer to Figure 4a and Table 4b. Describe and explain the changes in the output of the major farm products in Foshan between 2000 and 2018. (4 marks)

(c)

(i) Refer to Figure 4a and Table 4b. What are the major challenges faced by the agriculture in Foshan? (2 marks)

(ii) Refer to Table 4b and Figure 4c. Explain how the practice at Flower Production Centre A helps the farmers in Foshan tackle these challenges.

(d) Refer to Table 4b and Figure 4c. Discuss whether farming technology X may be applied to the cultivation of major farm products in Foshan. (4 marks)

Section D: Question 4 (cont.)

Curriculum Content – Regional Study of Zhujiang (Pearl River) Delta (ZDR)

Parts (a) & (b):

- Changing agricultural and industrial development
  - Changes and development in agriculture of ZDR

Parts (c) & (d):

- Changing agricultural and industrial development
  - Reasons for such changes and development

Section D: Question 4 (cont.)

- **What most candidates knew:**

✓Correct identification of the reduction of cultivated land and spatial differences in ZDR

✓Correctly stating simple reasons for the reduction of cultivated land

✓Correct identification of the changes in output of major farm products

✓Correctly identifying the major challenges faced by the agriculture in Foshan

✓Good knowledge of advantages of greenhouse and merits of the flower production centre

Section D: Question 4 (cont.)

- **Common mistakes / Misconceptions of candidates:**

× Described the increase in built-up area rather than using the data to explain the reduction of cultivated land

× Did not make good use of the information to explain the changes in output of major farm products (e.g. increase of GDP per capita, growth of total highway length)

× Elements written not with refence to the information provided (e.g. hydroponics, mechanization)

× Repeating the advantages of greenhouse when answering (d)

Section D: Question 4 (cont.)

- **Directions for better performance:**

- Making appropriate use of information provided, both in description and interpretation
- Correct use of terms e.g. automation, specialisation, agro-tourism
- Giving relevant answers regarding to different sub-questions, e.g. part (c): ‘practice at Flower Production Centre A’ to tackle the major challenges; part (d): ‘farming technology X’ to be applied to cultivation of major farm products

Section D: Question 5

Elective: Dynamic Earth

Account for the influence of rainfall on the occurrence of landslides in Hong Kong. Discuss the effectiveness of engineering measures in mitigating landslides caused by rainfall in Hong Kong.

(12 marks)

Section D: Question 5 (cont.)

Curriculum Content – Dynamic Earth

First Part:

- Geological hazard – Landslides
  - Causes of landslides in Hong Kong, including natural and human factors.

Second Part:

- Geological resources - Landslides
  - Slope management and landslide prevention

Section D: Question 5 (cont.)

- **What most candidates knew:**

✓The physical processes of rainwater leading to landslides

✓The relationship between stress and strength

✓Examples of landslides in Hong Kong related to rainstorms

✓General measures to mitigate the risk of landslides

Section D: Question 5 (cont.)

- **Common mistakes / Misconceptions of candidates:**

× *'Rainwater acts as lubricant in causing landslides.'*

× *'Heavy rainfall leads to soil erosion which then causes landslides.'*

× Unable to distinguish engineering measures to mitigate landslides 'caused by rainfall'

× Unable to name the engineering measures correctly

× Wrong measures (e.g. afforestation, public education) provided which could not prevent the occurrence of landslides

Section D: Question 5 (cont.)

- **Directions for better performance:**

- Pay attention to the question words- 'landslides caused by rainfall'
- Spell and write the geographical terms correctly
- Focus on relevant ways to mitigate landslides when discussing the effectiveness of engineering measures
- When discussing the effectiveness of the measures, take into account of the slope environment and the implementation of various measures

Section D: Question 6

Elective: Weather and Climate

Account for the physical factors leading to the occurrence of drought in North China. Discuss the effectiveness of the South-to-North Water Diversion Project as the solution to the drought problem in North China in the long run.

(12 marks)

Section D: Question 6 (cont.)

- ***Curriculum Content – Weather and Climate***

First Part:

- Relationship between weather hazards and human activities
  - Causes of drought in North China

Second Part:

- Relationship between weather hazards and human activities
  - Strategies adopted to combat droughts in North China, e.g. water transfer projects, improved farming methods, water conservation projects, proper water management
  - Evaluation of the effectiveness of these strategies

Section D: Question 6 (cont.)

- **What most candidates knew:**

✓ The climatic factors leading to low rainfall in North China

✓Relief and distance from sea are also factors affecting rainfall in North China

✓The main elements of the South-to-North water diversion project and the possible problems

✓Other measures to solve the drought problem

Section D: Question 6 (cont.)

- **Common mistakes / Misconceptions of candidates:**

× *'Drought is caused by low annual rainfall.'*

× *'Drought means water shortage.'*

× *'Low evaporation in winter is a cause of drought in North China.'*

× Unable to identify the geographical extent of North China correctly

× Unable to elaborate the benefits of the South-to-North water diversion project to North China when discussing its effectiveness

× Over-emphasising the 'cost' and 'technical factors' in the discussion

× Did not attend to the 'supply-demand' issue of water in the discussion

× Wrong measures (e.g. afforestation, cloud seeding) stated which were not feasible to solve the drought problem in the long run

Section D: Question 6 (cont.)

- **Directions for better performance:**

➢Better understanding of the meaning of drought

'a state of serious water shortage when rainfall is much lower than the average'

➢Better understanding of the geographical extent of North China and physical factors causing low and seasonal variation of rainfall

➢Taking both the benefits and possible problems into account when discussing the effectiveness of the project

➢Considering how to increase water supply and control water demand in the discussion

Section D: Question 7

Elective: Transport Development, Planning and Management

Describe the characteristics of transit-oriented development. Discuss the significance of transit-oriented development in affecting urban expansion in Hong Kong.

(12 marks)

Section D: Question 7 (cont.)

Curriculum Content – Transport Development, Planning and Management

First Part:

- Transport development and urban morphology
  - "Transit-oriented development" (TOD)

Second Part:

- Transport development and urban morphology
  - The impact of "TOD" on the transport and urban development of Hong Kong

Section D: Question 7 (cont.)

- **What most candidates knew:**

✓Railway transport is part of TOD

✓Transport development affects urban land use

Section D: Question 7 (cont.)

- **Common mistakes / Misconceptions of candidates:**

× *'TOD is equivalent to mass-transit railway syste*m'

× Limited knowledge of TOD

× Wrongly named the areas with TOD in Hong Kong (e.g. Shatin, Tung Chung)

× Narrowly explained the impact of railway development on urban expansion in Hong Kong

× Unable to take other factors (e.g. land rent, housing policy) into account in their discussion

× Unable to elaborate on both positive (intensify) and negative (slow down) impact of TOD on urban expansion in their discussion

Section D: Question 7 (cont.)

- **Directions for better performance:**

➢ Study the concept of TOD thoroughly

➢ Study the various impacts of TOD on urban development in Hong Kong, with reference to genuine examples

Section D: Question 8

Elective: Regional Study of Zhujiang (Pearl River) Delta

Account for the changes in land use pattern from rural-agricultural dominant to urban-industrial dominant in the Zhujiang Delta Region since the 1980s. Discuss the impact of urban-industrial dominant development on the environmental conditions in the region since 2000.

(12 marks)

Section D: Question 8 (cont.)

Curriculum Content – Regional Study of Zhujiang (Pearl River) Delta (ZDR)

First Part:

- Changing land use pattern
  - Changing land use pattern since the 1980s: from rural-agricultural dominant to urban-industrial dominant
  - Urban expansion as a result of economic development and urban growth

Second Part:

- Change, development and the natural environment
  - Environmental pollution in ZDR: causes, types, spatial distribution and variation over time

Section D: Question 8 (cont.)

- **What most candidates knew:**

✓The general change from rural-agricultural dominant development to urban-industrial dominant development in ZDR since the 1980s

✓The factors leading to the changes

✓Environmental problems in ZDR at an early stage of Economic Reform

Section D: Question 8 (cont.)

- **Common mistakes / Misconceptions of candidates:**

× 'Environmental problems in ZDR worsened as a result of industrialisation and urbanisation since 2000.'

× 'Greenhouse effect is one of the arising environmental issues.'

× Unable to focus on the 'changes in land use pattern'

× Unable to account for the spatial and temporal differences regarding the changes in land use pattern

× Unable to discuss the impact on the environmental conditions 'since 2000'

× Mentioning the 'Emptying Cage for the Birds Policy' but unable to elaborate its positive effect on the environment of ZDR

Section D: Question 8 (cont.)

- **Directions for better performance:**

➢ Focus on the relationship between urban-industrial development and the changes in land use pattern in ZDR in recent decades

➢ Study the spatial and temporal differences regarding the changes in land use pattern

➢ Learn both the positive and negative environmental impacts of urban-industrial development in ZDR by making reference to current data and information Screenshot_20230807_180404_RTHK On The Go.jpg

General Remarks and Recommendations:

1. Candidates should go back to basics to spell key geographical terms correctly, they should use them properly to show their understanding of the relevant topics.

2. Candidates should strengthen their understanding of key geographical concepts, particularly in learning the relationship between processes and the resulting features.

3. Apart from using textbooks, candidates should update their knowledge and information from different resources regarding the properties of the topics.

General Remarks and Recommendations: (cont)

4. Candidates should pay heed to new content and learning areas in response to the recent amendments in the curriculum.
5. Candidates should pay attention to key question words, and use relevant data to answer different sub-questions.
6. Candidates should read the questions carefully, and should present their answers logically rather than writing accounts or reciting knowledge without due consideration to its relevance to the question

THANK YOU

Q&A

Reminders for Candidates in 2024 Geography Examination

1. ***DO NOT*** *allow to use self-made transparent plastic sheets with gridlines in the examination*
2. ***DO NOT*** *use colour pencils, colour marker pens or highlighters*
3. ***CLEAR HANDWRITING*** *and* ***PAGE LAYOUT*** *are essential for accurate marking*
4. ***WRITE CLEARLY*** *by crossing out/ deleting all unwanted words*
5. *Mark carefully and accurately the* ***QUESTION NUMBER*** *on* ***EACH PAGE*** *of the Answer Book, especially in* ***Sections B & C of Paper 1***
6. *Start* ***EACH*** *question (not part of a question) on a* ***NEW*** *page*
7. *Study carefully the 2024 Handbook for Candidates*

Thank You for Your Participation